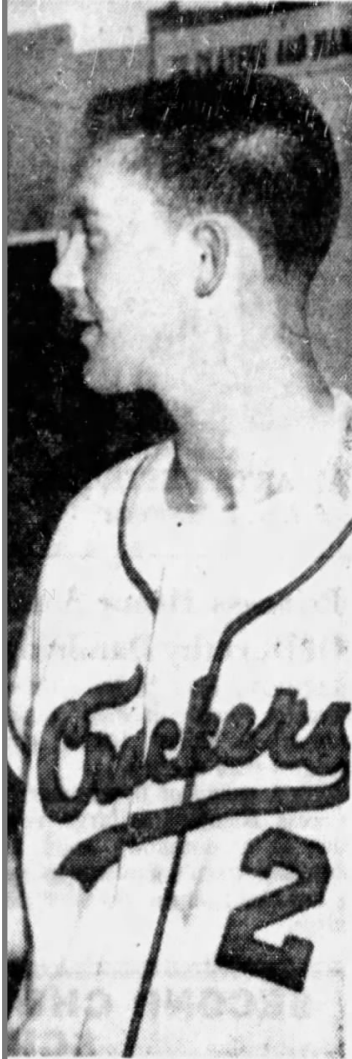


Montag, Willis Blows Decisive

By JESSE OUTLAR

Charlie Bicknell's chips-down relief pitching and a four-run fourth-inning rumpus, featuring



Staff Photo—Ken Patterson

CAME IN AT RIGHT TIME
ulate Charlie Bicknell

odling

arging third-degree assault. Ed-
ard Ertle, a fan, claimed he

Bob Montag's booming homer and Bobby Willis' bloop single, paid off in a 4-3 victory for Atlanta over New Orleans Thursday night.

The Pels, pecking away at what had been a three-run Atlanta lead, had closed the gap to the final margin and had the bases loaded with one down when Bicknell got the call in the eighth.

Bicknell gave the seant turnout of 1,096—most of the customers watched on TV—a chill by serving up three straight balls to pinch-hitter Emil Panko. He eventually retired Panko on a foul fly to Bill Reynolds in short right. He then chopped down husky Howie Goss on strikes to leave three frustrated Pels stranded.

In the next frame, Bicknell added two strikeouts and set down the side in order to wrap up starter Dick Grabowski's No. 4 victory and give the Crackers a split in the four-game set. Three of the thrillers were decided by one run.

Manager Clyde King and Pel pilot Andy Cohen had the strategy wheels humming, before Bicknell was brought on, and the Cracker boss hit the jackpot.

Lefty Jim Spencer, who had relieved Grabowski in the eighth, was ready to pitch to Harry Fisher, the hitting pitcher who batted sixth in the Pel lineup. But Cohen waved Fisher away and sent up right-handed hitting Panko, who had been benched due to a prolonged slump.

King countered with Bicknell, which turned out to be some of the finest strategy he'll ever pull off, for the right-hander has seldom been sharper.

The Crackers crammed all of their scoring and four of their seven hits into the rollicking fourth. Fisher was breezing along at a hitless clip, till Montag broke the spell with his No. 4 homer with one out in the big round. Sammy Meeks and Bob Boring followed with singles and Frank DiPrima walked to jam the bases.

Fisher almost climbed out of the hole, retiring Frank Sacka for the second out. But Willis bloomed a single over first and